

us in terms of money. My reluctance to set financial boundaries has always stemmed from a viewpoint that ‘it’s only money’, and that it’s not possible to put a price on the happiness of those I care about. However, this changes when you accept the fact that money is not just notes and coins, but a wellbeing currency in our own lives. We have to ensure that we respect ourselves enough to protect ourselves from being completely drained by those around us, or being so heavily influenced by external opinions that we forget what’s important to us. We explored people-pleasing and misconceptions around generosity in the previous two sections, and you might like to bring all of this insight together for a moment of reflection around money, your relationships and your self-worth. Jot down any lightning bolts, and I’ll meet you in the next section.

How to set boundaries in your relationship with money

There are certain areas of your relationship with money where porous or non-existent boundaries can cost you a lot of cash, and your peace of mind. Some of these, such as struggling to say no to expensive plans, we’ve covered, but here are a few more places where it’s common to struggle with boundaries:

- Agreeing to work for free, or for less than you’re worth.
- Lending money to others when you can’t afford it, or it will impede your financial goals.
- Allowing others’ opinions of you to influence your behaviour with money.